

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/20: The one question and the three offices

~~VARIABLE CLAUSE (verbatim): "Reason, Revelation and Faith."~~

CENTRAL QUESTION: on what may a religious belief rest, and who audits the answer?

+-----+-----+-----+		
REASON -> ARGUES	REVELATION -> DISCLOSES	FAITH -> TRUSTS
infer / test /	general or special;	assent / trust /
interpret / regulate	propositional or event	commitment / hope
+-----+-----+-----+		
ALONE: reductionism	ALONE: unauthenticated	ALONE: arbitrariness
	authority (why THIS?)	or fanaticism
+-----+-----+-----+		

THESIS: three jobs, not three rivals for one job. Mutual audit, not hierarchy.

FORMULA TO WRITE: reason regulates | revelation discloses | faith receives.

TRAP: "faith = belief without evidence" destroys the 2020 and 2023 answers at once.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/20: Why the clause exists, and the only datable anchors

ORIGIN FAIL (conceptual, not calendar)

- 1 a tradition claims a disclosure unaided inquiry did not produce
 - > 2 the claim must be RECEIVED, so trust enters
 - > 3 rival traditions make INCOMPATIBLE disclosure-claims
 - > 4 a test is demanded, and every candidate test is itself contestable
 - ==> the clause exists because stages 3 and 4 cannot be waved away.

DATED PRINT ANCHORS (assert these years; invent no others)

1748 Hume, Enquiry, Section X	1874 Draper	1877 Clifford, Ethics of Belief
1896 White	1896 James, The Will to Believe	1979 W. C. Smith, Faith and Belief
1983 Plantinga, Reason and Belief in God		1991 Alston, Perceiving God
1997 Barbour, Religion and Science		1999 Gould, Rocks of Ages (NOMA)
2000 Barbour, When Science Meets Religion		2000 Earman, Hume's Abject Failure
2000 Plantinga, Warranted Christian Belief		

CITE BY WORK, NEVER BY YEAR: Augustine/Anselm (Proslogion 1); Aquinas (ST II-II qq.1-4); Kierkegaard (Fear and Trembling; Concluding Unscientific Postscript); Tillich (Dynamics of Faith); Buber (I-Thou); Hick (Philosophy of Religion); Gita 17.2-3; Kalama Sutta AN 3.65; Kevaddha Sutta DN 11; Yoga-sutra 3.37.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/20: Reason's five functions and its single limit

(a) CONSTRUCT natural theology Aquinas' premises, by inference to best
(b) TEST coherence no appeal to mystery makes a contradiction true
(c) INTERPRET scripture literal / analogical / historically conditioned
(d) DEFEND (apologetics) and correlatively criticise
(e) REGULATE veto, discipline, name defeaters <== 2021 hinge
SCOPE NOTE: natural theology argues TOWARD theological conclusions;
philosophy of religion also analyses language, experience and warrant. Narrower.
RATIONALISM: Clifford - "it is wrong always, everywhere, and for anyone, to
believe anything upon insufficient evidence."
LIMIT: the proofs are inconclusive; the transcendent may EXCEED reason.
>>> EXCEED, never CONTRADICT. The whole position rests on that word. <<<
OBJECTION (Kant): speculative reason may not go beyond possible experience.
REPLY: metaphysical inference concerns the CONDITIONS of experience, not a
further observed object.
PRESUPPOSITION: reality is intelligible; reason is neither wholly corrupted nor
confined to empirical objects.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/20: The two middle terms that decide the marks

BINARY 1 constitutive reason | >>> REGULATIVE <<< | reason irrelevant

constitutive = GENERATES religious content (strict evidentialism)

REGULATIVE = vetoes contradiction, weighs testimony, disciplines reading,
names defeaters; does NOT author content

(Aquinas; critical rationalism; Plantinga's defeasible basicity)

irrelevant = faith immune; no criticism can touch it (insulated fideism)

BINARY 2 rational | >>> SUPRA-RATIONAL <<< | irrational

rational = grounds, coherence, cumulative evidence (preambles, motives
of credibility)

SUPRA-RATIONAL = EXCEEDS proof, does not contradict it (Aquinas' mysteries;
Kierkegaard's objective uncertainty)

irrational = contradicts logic or defies decisive evidence

ENTRY FEE FOR BOTH MIDDLE SEATS: DEFEASIBILITY. A belief that no consideration
could count against has bought safety by leaving the epistemic conversation.

RULE: this clause punishes binaries. Always supply the middle column.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/20: Revelation on two independent axes

	PROPOSITIONAL	NON-PROPOSITIONAL
	truths communicated	God's acts / self-presence
GENERAL (all)	nature and conscience read as conveying truths	world experienced as gift, presence or address
SPECIAL (particular)	scripture / prophet / tradition delivering DOCTRINE for assent -> Aquinas' MYSTERIES	a particular history received as divine action; doctrine = community's interpretation -> Hick's EXPERIENCING-AS

AXIS 1 = scope and medium (who can access it?)
AXIS 2 = what revelation IS (content, or encounter?) THEY CROSS. NOT ONE LADDER.
THREE WORDS THAT ARE NOT SYNONYMS
 REVELATION = the disclosure | INSPIRATION = divine-human authorship of the
 record | INFALLIBILITY = freedom from error. They can come apart.
TRAP: collapsing the two axes makes the 2025 Q6(c) fifteen-marker unanswerable.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/20: Propositional revelation, and natural vs revealed theology

could not discover or securely know.

ARGUMENT: (1) God can disclose -> (2) prophets and scripture mediate ->

(3) signs, testimony and coherence warrant reception -> (4) doctrine articulates.

PRESUPPOSITION: a personal God acts in history; reliable transmission is possible.

NATURAL THEOLOGY	REVEALED THEOLOGY
premises publicly accessible	premises taken to be delivered
content: that God exists, some attributes	content: the MYSTERIES - Trinity, Incarnation
= Aquinas' PREAMBLES	= accepted on disclosure, above reason not against
Indian instance: Nyaya inference to Isvara	warranted by signs, testimony, coherence

THE DISTINCTION IS ONE OF EPISTEMIC ACCESS - not importance, not rationality,
not chronology. Both speak about God; both reason; the premises differ.

INDIAN COMPLICATION: Mimamsa's AUTHORLESS (apauruseya) Veda is authoritative and
is NOT a creator God's speech -> scriptural authority with NO revealer.

OBJECTION: rival revelations + circular authentication weaken certainty.

REPLY: cumulative criteria - coherence, moral fruit, testimony, transformative
power - WITHOUT pretending they are tradition-neutral.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/20: Non-propositional revelation and experiencing-as

HICK'S CHAIN

EVENT (religiously ambiguous) -> FAITH perceives it AS divine action ->
COMMUNITY conceptualises the encounter -> DOCTRINE; diversity of doctrine now
reflects differing interpretive schemes.

PRESUPPOSITION: experience is always concept-laden; divine freedom is not
exhausted by statements.

KEY DISTINCTION: an event is not automatically revelation for every observer.

"Revelatory event" names an EXPERIENCED-AS structure, not a surface property.

Canonical illustration: one event, two true descriptions - secular causal,
and providential.

OBJECTION: if interpretation constitutes revelation, PROJECTION threatens.

REPLY (Hick): moral-spiritual transformation; the resistance of reality to
arbitrary interpretation. >>> Neither reply is decisive - say so. <<<

2022 Q5(d) VERDICT STRUCTURE

objective side : divinely communicated content would be true unreceived

subjective side: it becomes revelation FOR someone only through faith

==> faith is indispensable to RECEPTION and EFFICACY, not to occurrence.

Hold BOTH halves; conceding the first costs nothing.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/20: Six authentication tests, six limits

1 SOURCE / TESTIMONY *competent, sincere, suitably placed, independently*

supported? LIMIT: testimony transmits error as well as truth

2 COHERENCE *self-contradiction? clash with secure knowledge?*

..... LIMIT: coherence does not establish DIVINE origin

3 MORAL-SPIRITUAL FRUIT *truthfulness, compassion, transformation?*

..... LIMIT: useful effects occur under FALSE beliefs

4 TRADITION / COMMUNITY *publicly transmitted, criticised, corrected?*

..... LIMIT: endurance may preserve power or bias

5 EXPERIENCE + MIRACLE-SIGN *event resistant to ordinary explanation, fitted to the message? LIMIT: an anomaly authenticates no ONE reading*

6 CROSS-REVELATION *how does it answer rival disclosures?*

..... LIMIT: criteria are rarely tradition-NEUTRAL

2024 Q7(b) VERDICT FORMULA: a revelation-claim is warranted, if at all, by a CONVERGENCE - internal coherence, moral fruits, the recipient's experience, communal transmission and congruence with reason - no one of which is decisive, and none of which is neutral between traditions.

"OWN COMMENTS" = rank the six yourself. The limits are where those marks sit.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/20: Circularity, competing revelation and the diversity handover

THE CIRCLE

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scripture --authenticates--> God --authorises--> scripture
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VICIOUS if the circle is the ONLY support offered.

ARGUABLY VIRTUOUS once independent testimony, coherence, moral fruit and cross-tradition comparison enter it. Many epistemic practices use reciprocal support; the live question is whether THIS circle is vicious or a coherent web.

HERMENEUTIC RULE: scripture requires interpretation; AUTHORITY DOES NOT ELIMINATE HERMENEUTICS.

COMPETING REVELATION: rival scriptures cannot all be literally infallible in incompatible claims.

REPLY: distinguish core disclosure from historically conditioned interpretation.

COUNTER: critics fairly call that move REVISIONARY.

FIREWALL: competing revelation is used here only as an AUTHENTICATION and DIVERSITY DEFEATER. Complete pluralist theory and the absolute-truth debate belong to the Religious Pluralism owner.

HANDOVER LINE: the residual problem is DIVERSITY, not evidential poverty.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/20: Faith - seven tenets

(7) FRUITS a transformed pattern of life, by which it is tested

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(6) COMMUNITY tradition that transmits AND disciplines it

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(5) HOPE oriented to a good not yet secured

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(4) COMMITMENT the will engages; risk is accepted

^

(3) TRUST exceeding the available evidence <== FAITH DEPARTS HERE

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(2) ASSENT to some content; faith is never contentless feeling

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(1) ULTIMATE OBJECT God, Brahman, dharma, or another final focus

STEPS 1-2 are shared with belief. STEP 3 is the departure.

STEPS 4-7 are what belief alone never supplies.

2020 Q7(c) RULE: the stem prints TWO deliverables. Enumerate the tenets FIRST,
then run the differentia table. Doing one of the two loses about half the marks.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/20: Faith versus belief - six axes and the supports

AXIS	BELIEF	FAITH
object	a proposition	a person, reality or ultimate
grammar	believe THAT	believe IN / trust
mode	cognitive assent	assent PLUS trust, commitment, risk
voluntariness	largely involuntary	engages the will; can be GIVEN
failure-mode	falsehood	betrayal, infidelity, apostasy
degrees	degrees of confidence	degrees of fidelity and depth

DECISIVE TEST: a difference in how something can FAIL is a difference in what it IS. Betrayal is not a species of falsehood.

SUPPORTS: Aquinas - fides quae creditur (the faith WHICH is believed = content) / fides qua creditur (the faith BY WHICH one believes = act and disposition);
W. C. Smith, Faith and Belief (1979) - modern narrowing of "belief";
Tillich - ULTIMATE CONCERN, whose failure is IDOLATRY, not doubt;
Buber - the I-Thou relation is irreducible to I-It propositions.

INDIAN: Gita 17.2-3 grades trust (sraddha) sattvika / rajasa / tamasa, and "as is one's sraddha, so is one"; Advaita makes it the trust that ENABLES inquiry, replaced by realisation; Buddhist trust (Pali saddha) is verification-directed - Kalama Sutta, AN 3.65.

OBJECTION: "believing in" reduces to "believing that X exists and is trustworthy".

REPLY: one may believe a person reliable and still refuse to entrust anything.

VERDICT LINE: faith is not a weaker belief; it is a different act.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/20: Aquinas - the two storeys and the three-way location

ONE TRUTH, TWO ROUTES – both issue from God, so they CANNOT genuinely conflict,

apparent conflict = defective reasoning OR defective interpretation.

UPPER STOREY MYSTERIES (e.g. the Trinity) reached only through revelation

ABOVE reason, never AGAINST it

----- HINGE: MOTIVES OF CREDIBILITY -----

LOWER STOREY PREAMBLES (e.g. that God exists) reachable by unaided reason

WHERE FAITH SITS

KNOWLEDGE	FAITH	OPINION
firm assent WITH	firm assent WITHOUT	assent WITHOUT firmness;
sight/demonstration	sight	fears the opposite is true

==> faith takes FIRMNESS from knowledge and UNSEENNESS from opinion: a MEAN.

THE ACT, IN FOUR MOVES: revealed truth exceeds demonstrative sight -> testimony
supplies the object -> the WILL commands the intellect where evidence is
non-coercive -> GRACE orients the person toward divine truth.

SOURCE: Summa Theologiae II-II qq.1-4. PARAPHRASE; never fabricate a quotation.

OBJECTION: will-governed belief risks VOLUNTARISM.

REPLY: motives of credibility + rational preambles make assent reasonable
though not demonstrative; the will acts only where evidence is non-coercive.

2025 Q5(e) DEMAND: the MECHANISM of reconciliation - name the two storeys and
the hinge. Description of Aquinas' piety scores nothing.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 13/20: Kierkegaard and the permission ladder

KIERKEGAARD: objective uncertainty + infinite personal concern -> SUBJECTIVE

APPROPRIATION. Abraham dramatises the paradox and the "teleological suspension of the ethical". TARGET = the claim that an objective system can REPLACE existential decision.

>>> He does NOT license contradiction, irresponsibility, or evidence-free belief in general. State this disclaimer every time. <<<

STRICTEST -----> LOOSEST

CLIFFORD	CRITICAL	JAMES	PASCAL	INSULATED
evidentialism	RATIONALISM	will-to-believe	wager	FIDEISM
believe only	commit, keep	living, forced,	prudential	immune to
on sufficient	open to	momentous +	choice under	criticism
evidence	criticism and	evidence cannot	uncertainty	
	defeaters	decide		
COST:	COST: nothing	COST: undecid-	COST: NO	COST: licenses
disqualifies	is ever finally	able options	evidence of	fanaticism;
far more than	settled	only; NOT belief	truth; many-	forfeits
religion		at will	gods +	philosophical
			authenticity	standing

SLOGAN CONTROL: the "because it is absurd" formula is NOT verified Tertullian wording. Use it only as a later slogan for extreme fideism.

SUPRA-RATIONAL is not IRRATIONAL: exceeding proof differs from contradicting it.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 14/20: The bench - ten positions and the risk each runs

POSITION	REASON	REVELATION	RISK
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Rationalism/evidentialism (Locke, Clifford, Flew)	judge	must be evidenced	reduction of commitment
Aquinas	preambles, coherence	mysteries beyond reason	two-tier tension
Fideism	limited or irrelevant	authoritative	arbitrariness
Hick	interprets critically	event / self- disclosure	projection
Mimamsa	interprets injunction	AUTHORLESS Veda, not creator's speech	cross-tradition warrant
Advaita	manana removes doubt	sruti discloses Brahman	scriptural circularity
Reformed epist. (Plantinga)	not sole arbiter	may be received basically	RELIGIOUS DIVERSITY
Alston	critical, non-found'l	mediated in practice	circularity shared with sense perception
Barbour's typology	model-dep.	model-dependent	descriptive, not normative

FOUR RECURRING CRITICISMS + REPLIES

evidential challenge -> testimony, cumulative evidence, practical commitment
 competing revelation -> core disclosure vs historically conditioned reading
 circularity -> reciprocal support; is the circle vicious or a web?
 fideist immunity -> constrained by non-contradiction and ethical fruits
 METHOD: use TWO rows the stem forces into contact + ONE Indian row as a check.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 15/20: Evidentialism against Reformed epistemology

EVIDENTIALISM

- LOCKE assent proportioned to the probability of the evidence
- CLIFFORD "The Ethics of Belief" (1877) - MORAL wrong to believe on
 insufficient evidence; the SHIPOWNER example
- FLEW presumption of atheism: burden on the affirmative; the default is
 NOT-believing, not agnosticism

JAMES (The Will to Believe, 1896)

where an option is LIVING, FORCED and MOMENTOUS and evidence is genuinely inconclusive, the passional nature may lawfully decide; and Clifford's rule is ITSELF a passional preference for avoiding error over gaining truth.

LIMIT: undecidable options only; never belief AGAINST evidence.

PLANTINGA (1983; Warranted Christian Belief, 2000)

- (1) the objection presupposes CLASSICAL FOUNDATIONALISM: rational = self-evident, incorrigible, evident to the senses, or inferred from these
- (2) that criterion is SELF-REFERENTIALLY INCOHERENT - it is none of those
- (3) and TOO NARROW - memory, other minds, beliefs about the past
- (4) so basicity is not confined to that list
- (5) belief in God formed in appropriate circumstances (gratitude, guilt, wonder, reading scripture) is PROPERLY BASIC - grounded, not inferred

WARRANT = true belief from faculties FUNCTIONING PROPERLY, in an APPROPRIATE ENVIRONMENT, on a DESIGN PLAN AIMED AT TRUTH; sensus divinitatis supplies it without argument. PAYOFF: IF theism is true, theistic belief is very likely warranted -> no viable de jure objection independent of the de facto question.

GREAT PUMPKIN -> reply: grounding, DEFEASIBILITY, disciplined practice -> counter: criterion becomes community-relative -> "Son of Great Pumpkin" returns for well-established rival traditions.

ALSTON, Perceiving God (1991): no doxastic practice - sense perception included - can be validated non-circularly.

INDIAN ANALOGUES (EXACT, do not loosen)

Mimamsa svatah-pramanya (intrinsic validity, valid until defeated) ~ PROPER BASICITY | Nyaya paratah-pramanya (validity established by something further) ~ EVIDENTIALISM | Carvaka = the strict evidentialist limit.

VERDICT: justification is internal to a doxastic practice -> the live objection changes from INSUFFICIENT EVIDENCE to INCOMPATIBLE PRACTICES.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 16/20: Miracles - Hume's two Parts

HUME, Enquiry Concerning Human Understanding, SECTION X, "Of Miracles" (1748)

DEFINITION: "a violation of the laws of nature" by a particular volition of the Deity. >>> The definition is itself contested - see reply 1. <<<

PART I - THE A PRIORI BALANCE

- 1 a wise man proportions his belief to the evidence
- 2 laws of nature rest on UNIFORM, exceptionless experience - the strongest empirical evidence there is
- 3 testimony rests on experience of human reliability - strong but NOT uniform
- 4 a miracle report sets uniform against non-uniform; the weaker must yield
- 5 MAXIM: no testimony suffices unless its FALSEHOOD would be MORE MIRACULOUS than the fact it endeavours to establish - and even then, subtract the lesser marvel from the greater

PART II - FOUR A POSTERIORI CONSIDERATIONS

- (a) never enough witnesses of unquestioned good sense, education, integrity and public reputation with much to lose
- (b) a standing human PASSION FOR SURPRISE AND WONDER multiplies such reports
- (c) they flourish chiefly among ignorant and barbarous nations, or descend from such origins
- (d) CONTRARY MIRACLES CANCEL: rival religions' miracles support incompatible systems, so each set destroys the credit of the others

CONTINUED IN PANEL 17: the five replies, what survives, and the Indian contrast.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 17/20: Miracles - the five replies and the Indian contrast

FIVE REPLIES TO HUME (continued from Panel 16)

- 1 DEFINITIONAL - if a law is an exceptionless regularity, a genuine exception shows the law was MIS-STATED. SWINBURNE recasts a miracle as a non-repeatable counter-instance to an otherwise well-confirmed law.
- 2 EVIDENTIAL - SWINBURNE's principles of CREDULITY and TESTIMONY give memory, perception and report a prima facie right to be believed; Hume's rule disables them exactly where they would matter - question-begging.
- 3 BAYESIAN - EARMAN, Hume's Abject Failure (2000): PRIOR improbability is confused with POSTERIOR probability given testimony; independent witnesses of moderate reliability can raise the posterior arbitrarily high.
- 4 CIRCULARITY - (C. S. Lewis and others) to know uniform experience is against miracles you must already know all such reports are false.
- 5 CONTRARY-MIRACLES - the cancellation assumes rival reports are equally well attested and mutually exclusive.

WHAT SURVIVES: Part II as a permanent checklist of EVIDENTIAL CAUTION.

TOO STRONG: Part I, which would exclude testimony for ANY sufficiently improbable event, including well-attested scientific anomalies.

INDIAN CONTRAST (not a parallel): Yoga-sutra 3.37 declares the accomplishments (siddhi / vibhuti) OBSTACLES to samadhi though "accomplishments" in the outward-turned state; the Kevaddha Sutta (DN 11) has the Buddha reject displays of psychic power, preferring the "miracle of instruction"; Mimamsa's authorless Veda needs NO miraculous authentication.

VERDICT: Hume raises an unusually heavy burden; he does not show it unmeetable.

A miracle is at best evidence FOR THOSE ALREADY INSIDE an interpretive framework that identifies which events would count as divine action.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 18/20: Science and religion - four models, four costs

TAN BARBOUR: Religion and Science (1997); When Science Meets Religion (2000)

- 1 CONFLICT competing claims about the same world, so one must yield.
Two mirror versions: scientific materialism | scriptural literalism.
Historiography = the WARFARE THESIS: DRAPER, History of the Conflict between Religion and Science (1874); WHITE, A History of the Warfare of Science with Theology in Christendom (1896).
>>> NOW REJECTED by most historians of science as a polemical nineteenth-century construction. Saying so is a MARK-EARNING QUALIFICATION. <<<
 - 2 INDEPENDENCE separate domains, questions and languages, so no conflict.
GOULD, NOMA - Non-Overlapping Magisteria, Rocks of Ages (1999): science = empirical fact and theory; religion = ultimate meaning and moral value.
Neo-orthodoxy and Wittgensteinian language-games reach the same result.
COST: peace bought by forbidding either side to say anything the other could contest - which few believers or scientists accept.
 - 3 DIALOGUE distinct but TOUCHING at BOUNDARY QUESTIONS - why a universe at all, why intelligible, why constants that permit life - and at METHODOLOGICAL PARALLELS: models, metaphors, paradigms, theory-ladenness of data in both.
COST: fruitful but non-committal; conversation, not conclusions.
 - 4 INTEGRATION natural theology (fine-tuning); theology of nature (revising doctrine in the light of evolution and cosmology); PROCESS THOUGHT.
COST: hostage to the science of the day.
- ALTERNATIVE FRAME - HAUGHT: Conflict / Contrast / Contact / CONFIRMATION, the last adding that religion underwrites the world's intelligibility.
- INDIAN MATERIAL (distinctive, not an echo)
- VIVEKANANDA - Vedanta as experience-grounded and so science-compatible;
"science of the soul" >>> report as a CLAIM, never endorse <<<
- RADHAKRISHNAN - science and religion as levels of one integral experience
- AUROBINDO - evolutionary metaphysics = an explicit INTEGRATION model
- CLASSICAL ROOT - is the word (sabda) an INDEPENDENT means of knowledge alongside perception (pratyaksa) and inference (anumana)? Carvaka: no.
Nyaya and Mimamsa: yes. That IS "can revelation add anything?" in Indian dress.
- PRESUPPOSITION: that "science" and "religion" name two stable, comparable things - denied by the historicist critique, since both are modern and plural.
- OBJECTION: the typology is descriptively neat but NORMATIVELY EMPTY.
- REPLY: it classifies; argue model by model. The defensible position is a DOMAIN-SENSITIVE MIXTURE - independence about method, dialogue about boundary questions, conflict only where a religious claim is genuinely empirical.
- NORMATIVE POINT: technology settles what we CAN do, not what we SHOULD do, and not what a life is for.
- TRAP: do not narrate Galileo and call it the science-religion question.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 19/20: The Indian parity bench and the Advaita route

PARITY BENCH

is testimony independent? West: Locke/Hume reduce it to experience |
India: Nyaya and Mimamsa make the word (sabda) an independent means of
knowledge; Carvaka denies it
intrinsic or extrinsic validity? West: foundationalism vs proper basicity |
India: Mimamsa svatah-pramanya vs Nyaya paratah-pramanya <== EXACT PARALLEL
whose speech is scripture? West: God's word | India: Mimamsa AUTHORLESS
(apauruseya) - no author, human or divine
faith as trust? West: fides qua; Tillich's ultimate concern | India: sraddha
(Gita 17.2-3); Buddhist saddha - verification-directed (Kalama Sutta)
reason's role? West: preambles, coherence, apologetics | India: manana; tarka
auxiliary, never independently probative in Vedanta
miracles as authentication? West: central to apologetics | India: siddhis are
OBSTACLES (YS 3.37); the Buddha rejects displays <== CONTRAST, not parallel
ADVAITA ROUTE: sruti/sabda -> sraddha makes inquiry possible -> SRAVANA
(hearing) -> MANANA (reasoning removes doubt) -> NIDIDHYASANA (assimilation)
-> direct realisation; trust is REPLACED by realisation, not preserved.
CONTINUED IN PANEL 20: the eleven verified routes and the answer spine.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 20/20: The eleven verified routes and the answer spine

2019 Q5(a) 10m self-revelation: faith or reason -> choose faith for reception
2020 Q5(a) 10m religion vis-a-vis science/technology -> Barbour + normative
2020 Q7(c) 15m tenets of faith; faith vs belief -> seven tenets + six axes
2021 Q7(a) 20m reason and faith; reason as regulative -> regulative not
constitutive
2022 Q5(d) 10m faith indispensable for revelation -> reception vs occurrence
2023 Q5(b) 10m can religious beliefs be justified -> name the STANDARD
2023 Q6(c) 15m rational and irrational aspects -> add the SUPRA-RATIONAL
2024 Q5(d) 10m role of reason in religion -> four functions + the limit
2024 Q7(b) 15m epistemic justifications of revelation -> six criteria, ranked
2025 Q5(e) 10m Aquinas' intellectual assent -> two storeys + the hinge
2025 Q6(c) 15m natural vs revealed theology -> inside the propositional model

ANSWER SPINE

10m: define the term asked -> internal relation -> one distinction -> one
objection -> direct verdict
15m: frame the warrant problem -> the model in steps -> criteria of
justification -> rival model or Indian comparison -> objection and reply
20m: map the three concepts -> strongest harmony and conflict models ->
presuppositions -> competing-revelation and evidential objections ->
Indian-Western comparison -> defended synthesis

SIX-STEP DISCIPLINE: define the disputed term | say whether the issue is
source, reception, warrant or commitment | reconstruct one named position |
add the strongest objection and reply | use one exact Indian comparison |
end with a graded verdict AND the defeater that would change it.

QUALIFIED CONCLUSION: rational religion is neither proof without trust nor
trust without criticism. Faith may go beyond coercive proof; it forfeits
philosophical standing when it claims a right to go AGAINST reason, or a right
to be exempt from correction.